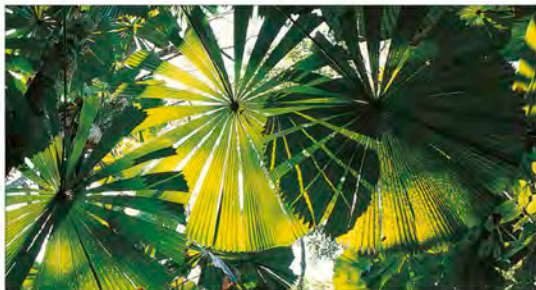


HOW PLANTS MAKE FOOD

Hungry animals can go out hunting for their food—but plants cannot. Instead, they make their own food in their leaves by using light from the sun, water from the soil, and carbon dioxide from the air. A plant's way of making food is called photosynthesis. It takes place during the day when the leaves are absorbing sunlight.

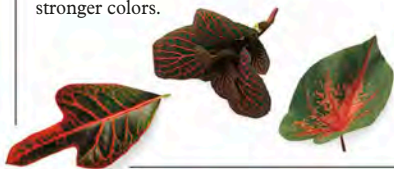


Reach for the sun

These palms grow in the shade of tall trees. Their leaves are arranged like fans to help them catch all the light they can.

Colorful cover-up

All leaves contain green chlorophyll. But in some leaves the green is hidden from sight by other, stronger colors.



The roots take up water from the soil. It is drawn up the stem to the leaves.

The leaves of all plants contain a special pigment that gives them their green color. It is called chlorophyll, and it is essential for photosynthesis.